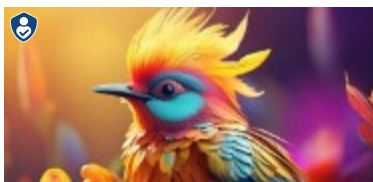


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Play a popular grunge song such as Nirvana's "Smells Like Teen Spirit" next to a classic Delta blues song like "Rollin' And Tumblin'" by Muddy Waters and disregard the lyrics and you will hear two types of music that seem to be polar opposites. Grunge has a harsh, loud, almost obnoxious sound with heavy distortion on the instruments and the lead singer is usually screaming into the microphone. The Delta Blues on the other hand has a softer more melodic folksy sound that uses basic instruments and the vocals are relaxed.

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grunge music and grunge culture. Although I was born in '96, which was a couple years after the height of grunge, I can still see the after effects of this music and can even still hear it on the radio. However in regards to the Delta blues, I have absolutely no exposure. This music was well before my time and I have never been any where near the south. What little I did know about the blues certainly did not strike me as being similar to grunge. That is until further research and analysis on the topics caused me to change my opinion. Although from different times and ethnic groups, the culture that formed these musical groups, the popularization and demise of the genres, and the message that the music from these genres bring share striking similarities.

The first similarity between the two music genres is the historical context that the music was born out of. The start of blues music can be traced back to African Americans during the time of slavery and continued on into the twentieth century where African Americans were isolated and oppres...

... middle of paper ...

the music came from and the message brought by the lyrics and you can see a striking resemblance.

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The book depicts the story of culture conflicts of the music, which arose from the introduction of the foot-tapping, hip-swaying music now known as rock n' roll (Graarrq). The outcome of rock n' roll coincided with tremendous uproar in the movement to grant civil rights to African American. Trapped in the racial politics of the 1950s, rock n' roll was credited with and criticized for promoting integration and

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Paul, Minnesota University, Banfield informs students of Rhythm and Blues' history and how it came to be from unsung musicians who innovated the sound during the end of World War II to its involvement with Hip-Hop. Its sub-genres include Doo-Wop, Soul, Funk, Dance and Disco that are credited for evolving the music's five decade reign on the charts. Along with artists such as The Temptations, Sam Cooke, James Brown, Ray Charles, Aretha Franklin, Marvin Gaye, Al Green, Bobby Womack and Isaac Hayes who gave this music its raw energy and prowess to define an era of racial tension and the need for change. From the late 60's to the early 70's, Rhythm and Blues brought out a gritty sound to shout for a need to change by giving a voice to those who want change to happen. According to his book, *Representing Black Music Culture: Then, Now, and When Again?* Banfield talks about the “the rise and (he argues) the fall of

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Working in the fields of Mississippi Delta, Water's was brought up surrounded by the "field hollers" that provided blues with its distinctive vocal textures. Amongst these were also a number of musicians who were able to begin to break free from the confines of working the fields. Arguably the most notable being that of Robert Johnson who created a body of work which summed up the Delta culture and sound. At first this received little attention outside of Delta but it did influence other blues musicians in the area such as Muddy Waters and this is evident in his early acoustic recordings such as "Country Blues". Johnson's recordings also inspired Alan Lomax to visit Delta on behalf of the Library of Congress in search of similar artists. After recording some

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The author starts off by giving some background information on the blues and how the blues actually became music. Then, the authors transition quickly into how the blues and rock and roll are intertwined. They say that “blues guitarists were the first to use rock 'n' roll techniques, such as feedback and distortion”(Roberts). After this they transition on to say how rhythm and blues came about saying how Muddy Waters, an R&B singer had a “heavy electric guitar sound” that influences kids that grew up to be famous rock singers. In the 1950’s Alan Freed began playing R&B songs on his radio station and and referred to the morphed blues music as rock and roll; kids loved this new type of music and were now constantly listening to it (Roberts). The authors acknowledge how people did not originally like blues and

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